

BRIEF ALIGNED EXECUTIVE REPORT

Strategic Environment Mapping

Executive readout for Chris' first submission.

PRIMARY ANSWER

The strategic environment around Yousician is broader than direct competitors: music learning, hobby discovery, AI, songs, hardware, creators, education, rights, investors, media, awards and funding all shape the market.

This report follows the new direction: simpler platform, agreed journey categories, small key player set, triage first, deeper research only where priority is confirmed.

REPORT STATUS**Standard brief-aligned report**

Submission ready first read with explicit completion fields for credentialed Appfigures and internal relationship inputs.

BOARD READING ORDER

Answers first, priority actors second, proof and caveats after that.

CLAIMS CONTROLLED

Appfigures and relationship claims stay in completion layers until review approval exists.

DECISION USE CLEAR

The export is structured for prioritization, not exhaustive market cataloguing.

113 tracked records**4 key players****13 news grade moves****8 journey categories****3 guiding questions answered****1**

Direct answers to the guiding questions

The three guiding questions are answered before any supporting detail.

EXECUTIVE ANSWER

Who influences the future of music learning? Who is successful?

Use a four actor priority set before expanding coverage.

Start with Simply, Ultimate Guitar, Duolingo and Fender. Use Kahoot and the rest of the long tail as context until board and LST feedback confirms the next entities to deepen.

This keeps executive discussion on the few actors most likely to affect onboarding, practice habit formation, distribution and trust.

EXECUTIVE ANSWER

Who influences music as a hobby?

The hobby system is journey led, not competitor led.

The journey runs from discovery to identity: discovery platforms, instruments, learning apps, practice surfaces, creation tools, sharing loops and broader entertainment platforms all shape motivation.

The market view should explain how motivation travels across the journey instead of collapsing everything into direct learning apps.

EXECUTIVE ANSWER

Who shapes the strategic environment?

The next step is triage and proof, not more inventory.

Agree categories, rank importance, validate with board and LST, then deepen only the highest priority profiles.

This prevents low signal additions from crowding the decision story and preserves the review gate for unapproved claims.

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Priority actors and success surfaces

Top actors first; success is shown by influence surface, not by unvalidated app performance ranking.

01

Simply

Learning apps / Yousician + GuitarTuna

Direct learning competitor

Credentialed data pending

Useful benchmark for onboarding, motivation, pricing, and growth in app based music education.

02

Ultimate Guitar

Practice habits / GuitarTuna

Song and practice habit owner

Credentialed data pending

Strong influence on how hobbyists discover songs and move from inspiration to practice.

03

Duolingo

Education benchmarks / Yousician

Learning mechanics benchmark

Source-backed profile

Not music specific, but highly relevant for learning loops, retention, brand, and AI in education.

04

Fender

Gear channels / GuitarTuna

Hardware ecosystem owner

Relationship field open

Instrument brands can shape the beginner funnel before users choose a learning app.

These actors are shown first because they best answer the brief's core questions: learning influence, hobby influence, success surfaces, and strategic environment pressure.

Success surfaces

DIRECT APP BENCHMARK

Simply

Closest benchmark for onboarding, motivation, subscription learning and beginner conversion.

Appfigures still required for performance ranking.

REPERTOIRE AND PRACTICE SURFACE

Ultimate Guitar

Strong song intent and repertoire ownership around tabs, chords and repeat practice habits.

High behavioral relevance, but not a like for like learning subscription benchmark.

LEARNING MECHANICS BENCHMARK

Duolingo

Useful reference for habit loops, gamification, subscription learning, brand and AI in education.

Mechanic benchmark, not a music category comparator.

HARDWARE AND TRUST ROUTE

Fender

Instrument brand reach can influence beginner access, trust, bundles and possible route options.

Strategic channel pressure matters more than app parity.

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Key players at a glance

The key player set is intentionally small before the next triage round.

Start

1 key player

Fender

I decide to try and get what I need.

Learn

1 key player

Simply

I learn the basics and build skills.

Practice

1 key player

Ultimate Guitar

I practice, improve and stay motivated.

Broader

1 key player

Duolingo

Large platforms that may affect music, education, identity, attention, or M&A logic.

The first read keeps the key player set intentionally small. Add more only after board and LST feedback confirms the next priorities.

4

Ecosystem map and journey coverage

Visual map plus the agreed journey categories.



Center of gravity

Yousician sits between learning, practice and strategic adjacency pressures rather than inside a narrow app-only lane.

Highest pressure zones

Learn and Practice remain the closest decision fields; discovery, creation and identity add broader strategic pull.

How to read this map

Use proximity as strategic relevance and route overlap, not as a literal market share or performance ranking.

Discover

16 records / 0 key players
YouTube, Spotify, MIDiA Research

Start

12 records / 1 key players
Fender, Positive Grid, Yamaha

Learn

21 records / 1 key players
Simply, Pickup Music, Musora

Practice

17 records / 1 key players
Ultimate Guitar, Moises, Chord ai

Create

20 records / 0 key players
BandLab, Suno, Udio

Share

8 records / 0 key players
Spotify for Artists, TikTok for Artists, Music Ally

Identity

10 records / 0 key players
ABRSM, Berklee Online, Royal Conservatory of Music

Broader

9 records / 1 key players
Duolingo, Muse Group, Kahoot

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Journey category coverage

The agreed journey steps are shown individually, with broader platforms kept as triage records.

Discover

COVERED

Music discovery, artist platforms, media, culture and inspiration sources.

Start

COVERED

Instrument brands, hardware, retail channels and beginner access routes.

Learn

COVERED

Direct learning apps, curriculum, teachers, schools and education benchmarks.

Practice

COVERED

Song choice, tabs, practice utilities, feedback and habit formation.

Create

COVERED

Creation tools, AI music systems, DAWs, samples and production workflows.

Share

COVERED

Community, artist tools, rights, creator feedback and distribution surfaces.

Identity

COVERED

Music as culture, brand, recognition, trust, fandom and personal identity.

Broader platforms

TRIAGE

Spotify, Disney, Epic Games, Roblox, Netflix, Nintendo and major education brands are included as strategic adjacency records.

6 Last 24 months on the market

A compact view of who made the news for what.

2026-06 AI rights

AFM / major labels - Musicians union sued UMG and WMG over AI licensing related

Musicians union sued UMG and WMG over AI licensing related to Suno and Udio.

AI licensing disputes now extend from labels vs AI firms to musician compensation claims.

2026-06 Awards / iOS

Apple Design Awards - Apple announced 2026 Design Award winners and finalists.

Apple announced 2026 Design Award winners and finalists.

Clear benchmark for app craft, interaction, accessibility and award submission readiness.

2026-01 Funding / EU

EIC Accelerator - EIC Accelerator remained an EU route for high-risk, game-c

EIC Accelerator remained an EU route for high-risk, game-changing innovation.

Potential public-funding route for AI/learning/creative-tech initiatives.

2025-11 Awards / Android

Google Play - Google Play Best of 2025 continued as a platform-recogniti

Google Play Best of 2025 continued as a platform-recognition benchmark.

Useful for Android app-quality and editorial recognition planning.

2025-09 AI governance

Spotify - Spotify announced stronger AI protections for artists and

Spotify announced stronger AI protections for artists and songwriters.

Platform AI rules affect future music discovery, identity and rights expectations.

2025-08 AI practice / creation

Moises - Moises launched AI Studio for adaptive AI music creation s

Moises launched AI Studio for adaptive AI music creation support.

Practice utilities are moving toward creation co-pilots.

2025-08 AI music generation
ElevenLabs - ElevenLabs launched Eleven Music for prompt-based music ge
ElevenLabs launched Eleven Music for prompt-based music generation.
A major AI audio player moved directly into music creation.

2025-06 Artist insights
TikTok for Artists - TikTok launched an artist insights and promotional platfor
TikTok launched an artist insights and promotional platform.
Short-form discovery is becoming measurable artist infrastructure.

2025-01 Publishing / rights
Muse Group / Hal Leonard - Muse Group unified Hal Leonard US and Europe into a global
Muse Group unified Hal Leonard US and Europe into a global publishing powerhouse.
Song rights, notation, tabs and learning content are increasingly ecosystem-controlled.

2025-01 Artist tools
Spotify for Artists - Spotify framed Campaign Kit as a toolset for deeper fandom
Spotify framed Campaign Kit as a toolset for deeper fandom and audience goals.
Artist-success tooling influences the advanced learner / creator journey.

This first read timeline shows the most recent selected moves. The workbook and full report retain the wider 49 move evidence base; direct app performance still depends more heavily on Appfigures than press volume.

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Completion notes

Appfigures and relationships remain explicit completion layers without dominating the main story.

Appfigures

CREDENTIALLED INPUT

App-performance fields are prepared for Appfigures import; the report avoids invented revenue, download, ranking or country estimates.

EXTERNAL CREDENTIALLED EXPORT

IMPORT VERIFIED APP METRICS BEFORE PROMOTING ANY PERFORMANCE WINNER CLAIM.

Yousician links

INTERNAL INPUT

Relationship owner/status fields are prepared in the workbook and intentionally left open for Yousician completion.

YOUSICIAN INTERNAL REVIEW

APPROVE OR REJECT RELATIONSHIP CLAIMS IN THE REVIEW QUEUE BEFORE THEY APPEAR AS FINAL CLAIMS.

Sources

TRACEABLE

Market observations retain source context; deeper source audit remains appendix only.

SOURCE QA

KEEP UNRESOLVED AUTH OR REPAIR CASES IN APPENDIX STATUS UNTIL A VERIFIED REPLACEMENT IS LOGGED.

What is covered

The requested ecosystem map, key players, database, relationship fields, guiding answers, market moves, awards and funding.

What is deliberately not claimed

Deep product UX reviews, invented Appfigures estimates, inferred relationships, or app performance winners.



Package contents

The deck, report, database and completion templates form the current package.

Executive deck

PRIMARY SLIDE DECK

Deck PDF reading copy

NON-EDITING READ COPY

Market landscape report

NARRATIVE MARKET REPORT

Strategic environment database

RECIPIENT-FACING WORKBOOK

Submission package ZIP

ALL CURRENT FILES IN ONE PACKAGE

What it is

Executive ecosystem mapping with direct answers, market proof, and clearly qualified data caveats.

Performance caveat

App-based performance ranking is not finalized until credentialed Appfigures metrics are imported.

Appendix availability

Dashboard and source-audit appendix files are available on request, but are not part of the first read package.